



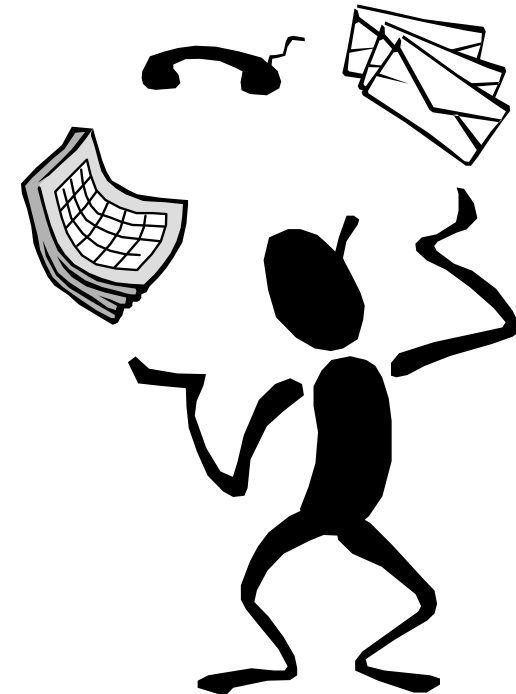
Building an EA Team – Extending to a Community of Practice

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Managing Director*

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- **Level-Set on Enterprise Architecture**
- **Steps to Building the EA Community of Practice**
- **Teaming Nature of Working Together on EA efforts**
- **Who are you looking for to be part of an EA Team?**
 - Skills and competencies of Enterprise Architecture Resources
 - And How They Compare to Other Architects
- **Where Does EA Report and How is EA Organized?**
 - Building the EA Team
 - Finding and Growing Team Members
- **What Do They Do?**
 - Roles & Responsibilities
 - Definition and Separation of Decision Authority
 - Areas of Knowledge
- **Evolution of the EA Team**
 - Scaling Amount and Coverage of Resources

- Figuring out who should be doing what is one of the top issues we help our clients with
- The landscape for EA is changing where it resides in an organization
- Many different options to consider
 - Where to report
 - Full-time vs. Part-time vs. Virtual
 - Decision Authority



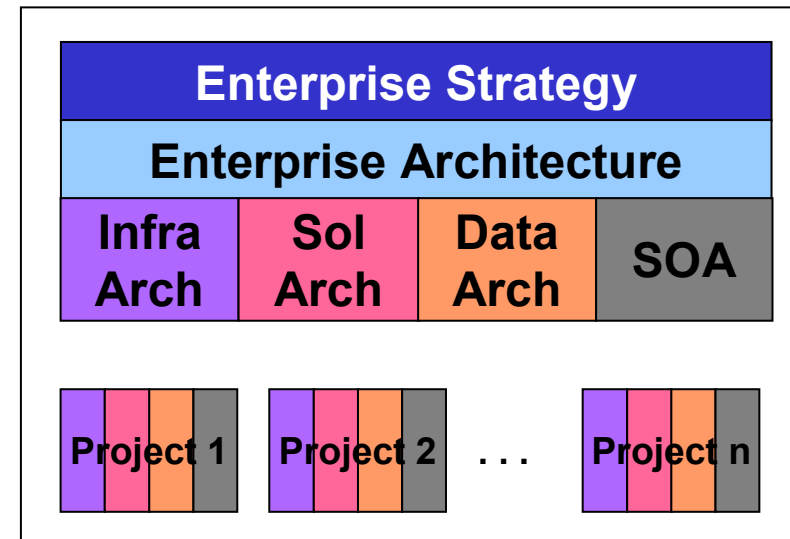
**What do you think of when you
hear the term
“Enterprise Architecture?”**

- **Enterprise Architecture (EA)** is a strategic management discipline that creates a single, holistic view of the business processes, systems, information and technology of the enterprise designed and optimized to create shareholder value by achieving both the long-term business strategy as well as current business objectives.
- **Intent of EA process:** Identify the impact of enterprise strategies and influence lower-level tactical, operational, and project decisions and activities to be more aligned with enterprise strategies.

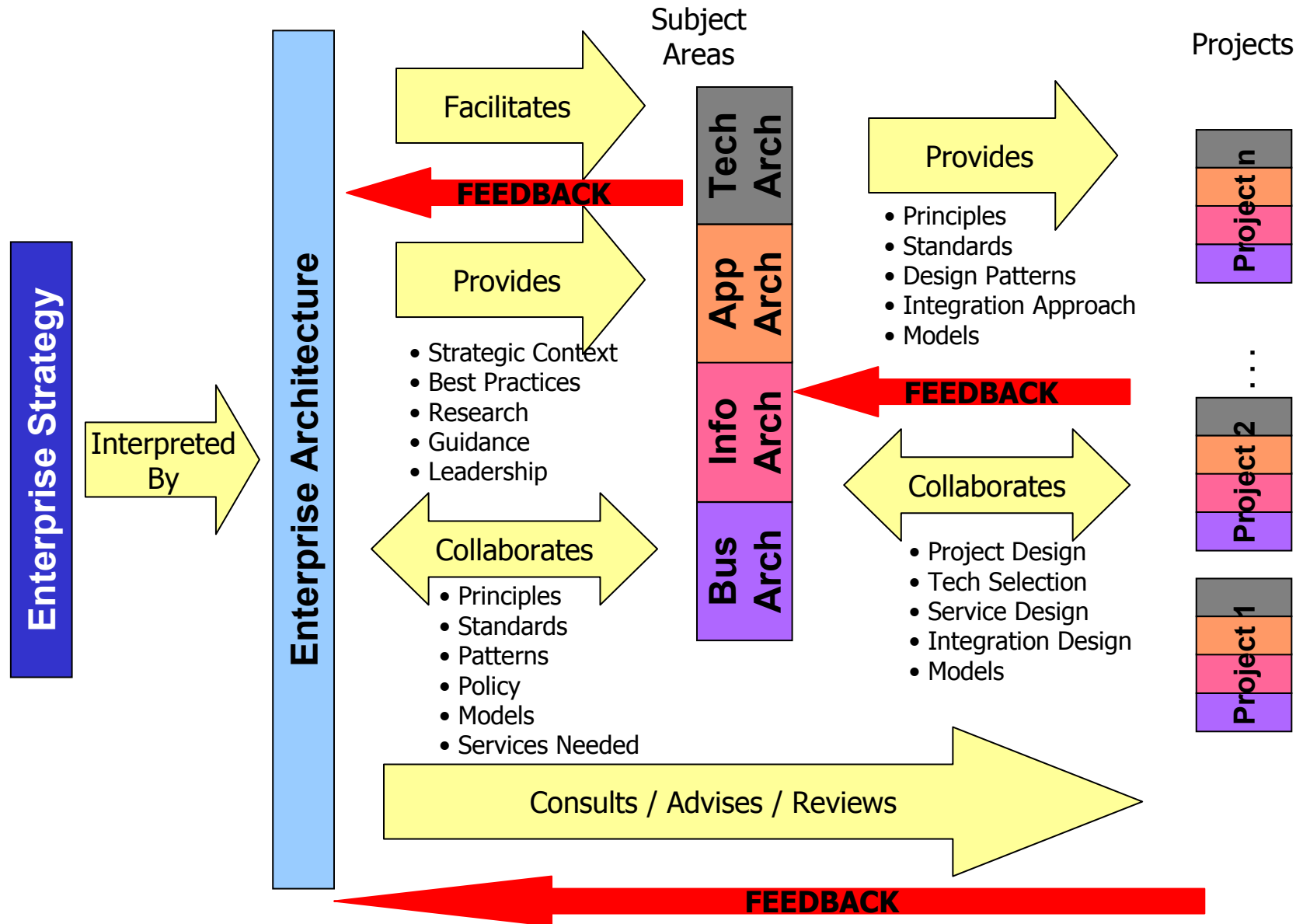
The primary design goal for enterprise architecture must be to enable efficient change in business capabilities through the *services* that enable them!

Enterprise Architecture vs. Architecture

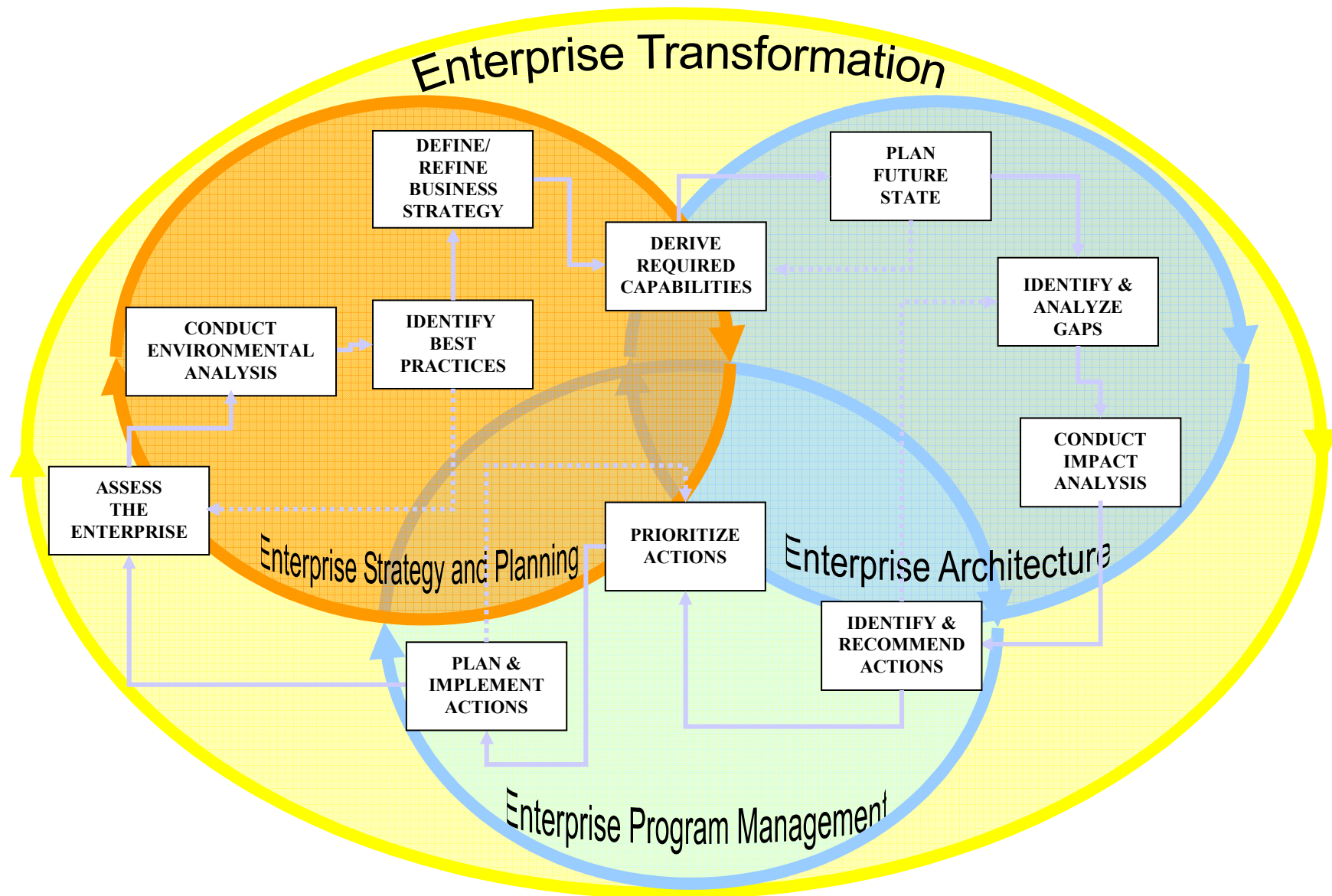
- **EA often mistaken for/positioned as:**
 - Business Architecture
 - Information Architecture
 - Systems Architecture
 - Solutions Architecture
 - Technical / Infrastructure Architecture
 - SOA
 - ??? Architecture
- **EA is a separate and distinct discipline that is higher-level, more strategic, and longer-term focused, but still integrated with other architecture disciplines**



Working Together: EA vs. Subject Area Architect vs. Project Architect



EA is One Part of the Transformation Effort



- **Dependent on:**

- YOUR Goals and objectives
- YOUR Level and degree of support
- YOUR Capabilities/Competency
- YOUR Governance
- YOUR Methodologies
- YOUR Degree of “Enterprise-first” actions
- YOUR Business Strategy
- YOUR Trend implications
- YOUR Performance Measurement System
- And ...

So there is not “ONE WAY” to implement and execute an EA practice – ASSESS YOUR SITUATION

**You must define EA for your
enterprise.**

Step #1 – Charter the EA Program

- **Establish the nature and objectives of EA within the context of your enterprise**
 - Define EA for your organization
- **Present the suggested EA groups and organization structure**
- **Describe what EA will do for the enterprise – Value Proposition**
- **Describe to senior management the mandate of the EA Program**
- **Become the basis of consistent language for communication, education and soliciting support**



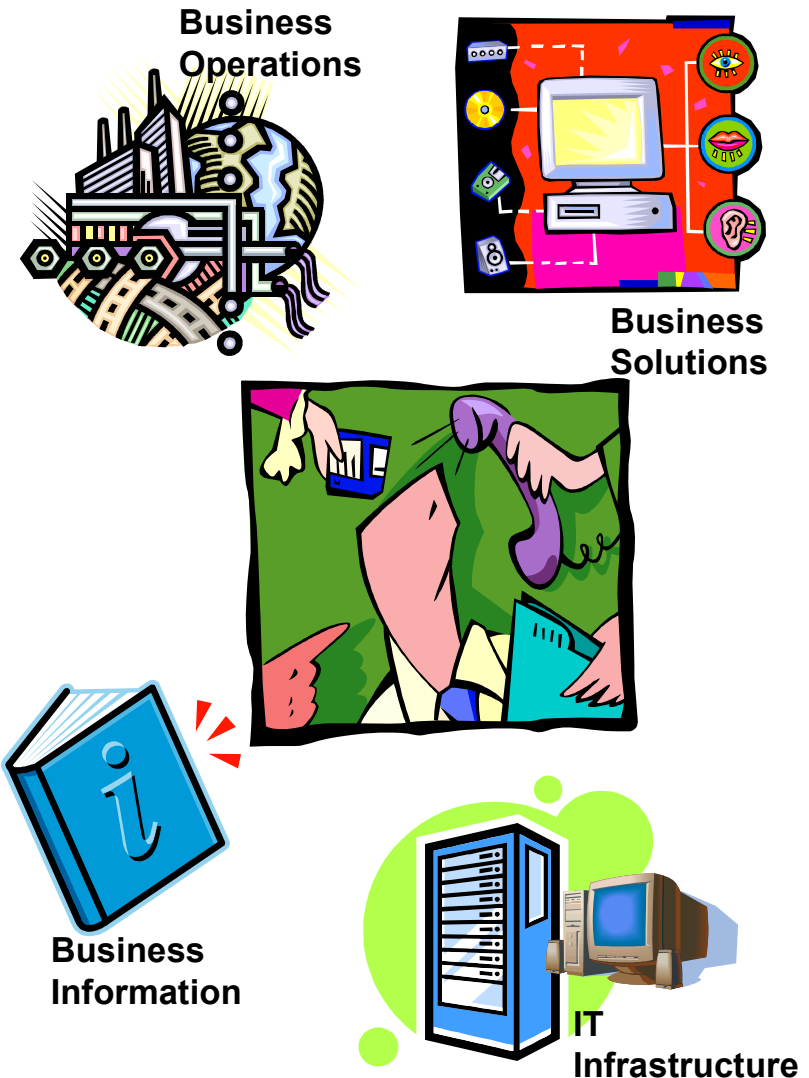
- **Introduction – Why Enterprise Architecture?**
- **Vision and Mission**
- **Scope**
 - Organization
 - Breadth
 - Depth
 - Time
- **Value Proposition**
- **Structure of Enterprise Architecture**
- **Enterprise Architecture Roles & Responsibilities**
- **Measurements**

**The scope of Enterprise
Architecture is more than
Enterprise Architects can handle.**

{EA > EA Team}

Step #2 – Staff a Core EA Team

- Too much work for One Person
- Too much work for One Centralized Group
- Coordination required across EA activities
- Nothing Stops! ... while EA is going on
- Too much depth and breadth of knowledge and experience is required
 - Collaboration is a key when trying to leverage multiple skillsets, subject matter expertise, and perspectives
- EA cannot be done effectively with only IT people involved
- Need a core group to coordinate, facilitate and drive the effort



Building and Operating an Effective EA Team

Considerations

- Where should the team reside in the organization?
- What skills are required?
 - Personal, Domain, Business, etc.
- Who should be on the team?
- What the team must do
- What team members must do
- How should the team manage time and activities?
- How does the team evolve over time?



Traits

- Business Knowledge
- Strategic Thinkers
- Systemic Thinkers
- Innovators – have a Vision
- Understands pitfalls of Perfectionism – are Pragmatists
- Broad and Deep Skills (enterprise and domain-specific)
- Appreciates a Portfolio Perspective
- Detail Oriented – Can understand and manage myriad objects and their relationships
- Process Oriented – Can create and operate EA and Governance processes
- Great Communications Skills
 - Writing, Speaking, Negotiating
- Politically oriented and/or connected
- Inspire, Influence, Persuade, Motivate – Lead!

Segmenting the Work to be Done

EA Planning	EA Development
• Defining/Refining Process • FW/Methodology/Tool Selection • Assigning Roles/Responsibilities • Soliciting Support and Sponsorship • Communication • EA Education • Trends Analysis • Emerging Technology and Enterprise Intelligence Research • Plan/Develop EA Governance Integration	• Alignment of Business Strategy • Principle Definition and Adoption • EBA/EIA/ETA/ESA Future State Definition • Develop Subject Area Knowledge • Research • Establish/Refine Standards • Design Configuration & Integration of Stds • Modeling – different types, contexts, scope, audience and depth • Gap Analysis with Current State • Implementation Planning • Roadmap to Enterprise Asset and Project Portfolios
• Project Architecture Consulting • Operations Integration • Procurement Integration • Project Review – Architecture Compliance Check • Exception Request Processing • Enterprise Portfolio Management support • Update EA Repository with Current State Deliverables	• Development and Maintenance of EA Repository with Web Access • Architecture Approval Process • Training for Domain and Project Architects • Architect Career Development • Metric Collection and Analysis
EA Implementation	EA Management

**For the Core EA Team members,
broader over deeper,
diversity over specialization,
and soft skills over technical skills**

- **Types of Architects**

- Enterprise
 - Domains: Business, Solutions, Services, Applications, Information, Data, Security, Operations, Process, Technical (network, platform, etc.), Software, Integration, etc.
- Project or Solution (Silo Architects)
 - Domains: Business, Solutions, Services, Applications, Information, Data, Security, Operations, Process, Technical (network, platform, etc.), Software, Integration, etc.

- **EA Community Members**

- Senior executives/corporate leadership, Business strategy teams, Line-of-business (LOB) management, IT leadership, IT business relationship managers, Portfolio Managers

- **Recruiting Team Members**

- Start by identifying EA Community – “Go To” individuals
- Engage by soliciting ideas
- Invite into the fold

- **The right team, in and of itself, doesn’t prevent the team from doing the wrong things**

- E.G., too much engineering support (see “slippery slope” later...)

Enterprise Architecture

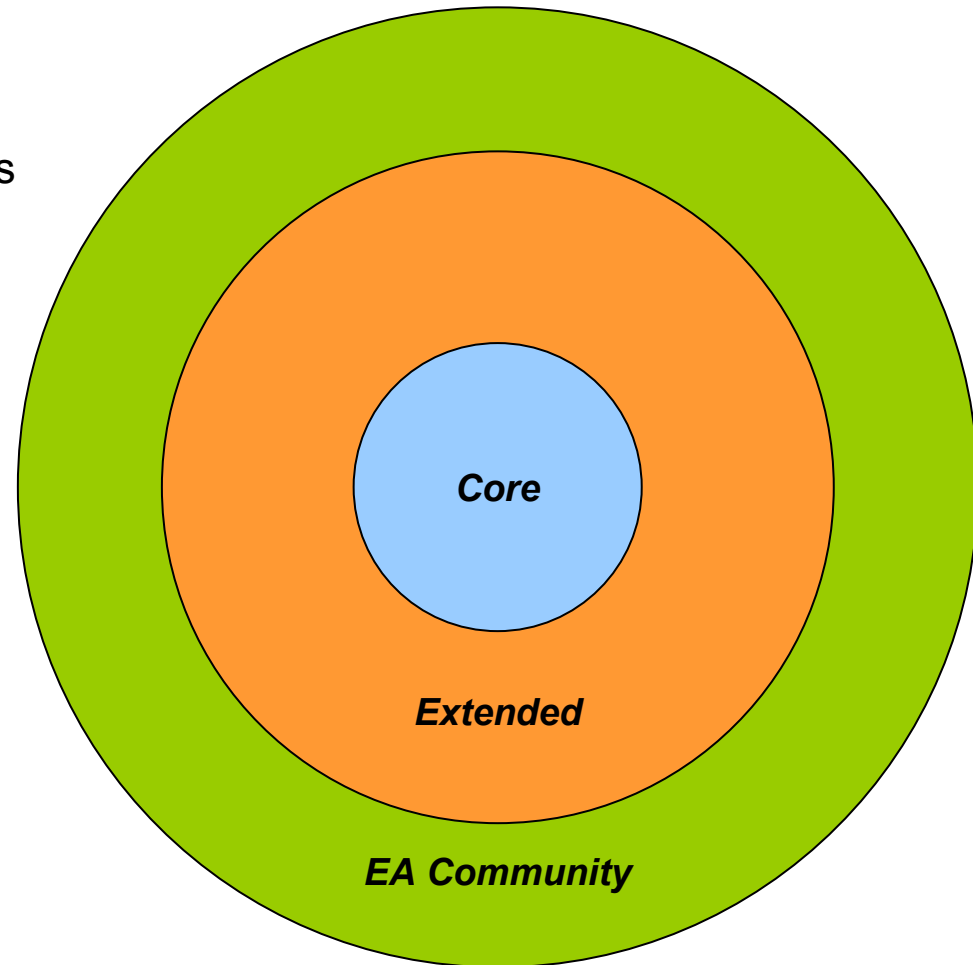
- **Broad Subject Area Knowledge**
- **Diversity of Experience**
- **Premium on Soft Skills**
 - Facilitation
 - Interpersonal / Communication
 - Organizational
 - Political
- **Puts the “Big Picture” first, but understands the need for details**
- **Wide Business Knowledge**
- **Easily handles abstract concepts**
- **Long-term motivated**
- **Consultative**
- **Striving for Reuse**
- **Solution Oriented**
- **Strong Analytical Skills**
- **Focus/Perspective**
 - Strategic
 - Transformational
 - Process-Oriented

Domain or Project Architecture

- **Deep Subject Area Knowledge**
- **Depth of Expertise**
- **Premium on Detailed/Technical Skills**
 - HW/SW/NW Configuration
 - Data & Information
 - Application Integration
 - Business Process Design
- **Attention to Detail, but understands the big picture**
- **Narrow Business Knowledge**
- **Must turn abstract into the concrete**
- **Short-term motivated**
- **Consultative**
- **Striving for Reuse**
- **Solution Oriented**
- **Strong Analytical Skills**
- **Focus/Perspective**
 - Execution
 - Implementation
 - Task-Oriented

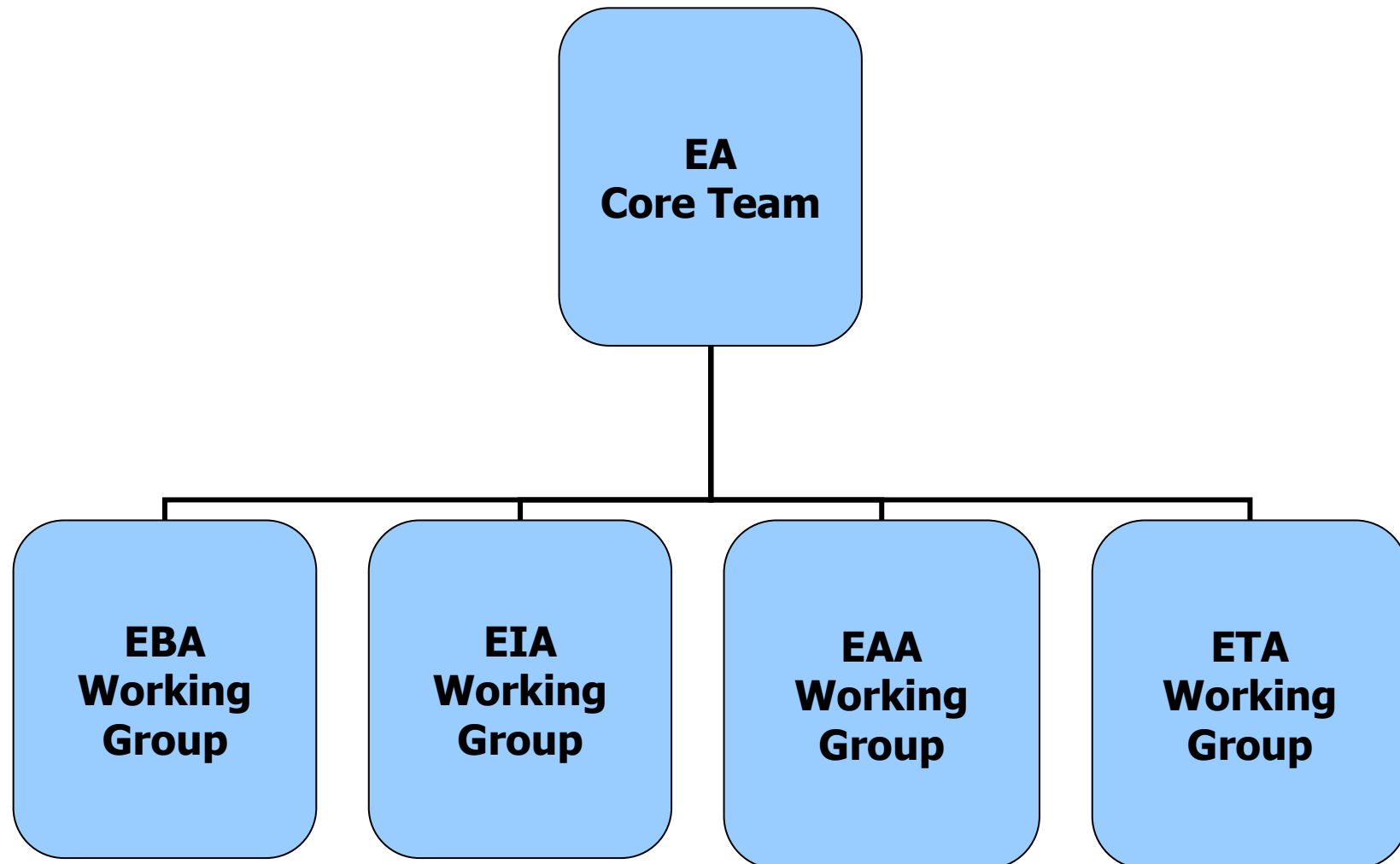
Step #3 – Define the Team Structure

- **CORE**
 - “Own” and operate EA Process
 - Small, avoid MEGA-teams
- **EXTENDED**
 - Subject matter experts
 - Contributors
 - Governance Participants
- **EA COMMUNITY**
 - Interested Parties
 - Users
 - Possible Contributors
- **Not necessary to be all-inclusive – Proxies**

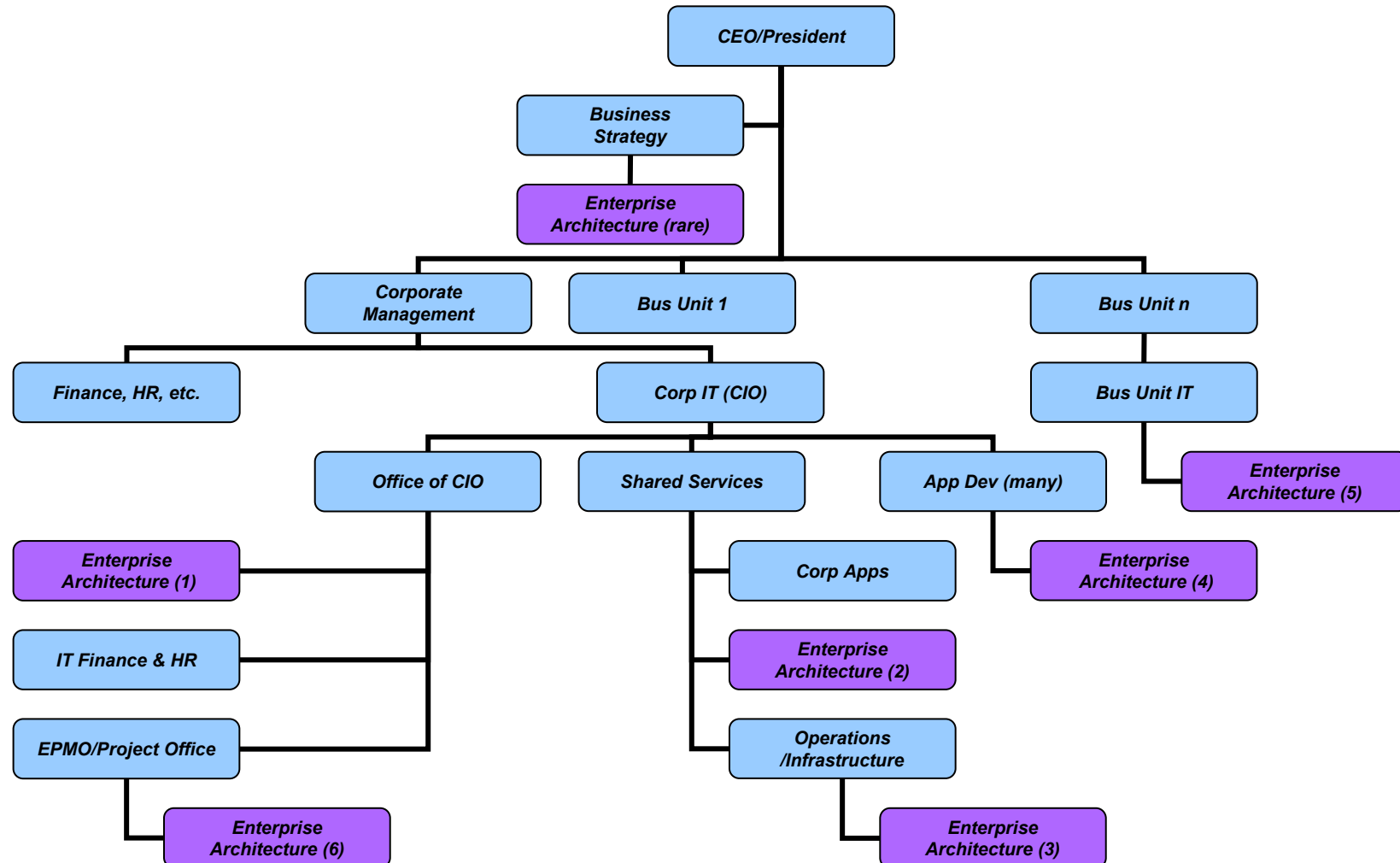


Broad participation provides a sense of ownership and credibility to the process

Sample Team Structure



Many Potential Reporting Locations



- **Too Tactical**

- App Dev, App Support and Operations management tends to be more focused on deadlines, tactics, and immediate issues/problem resolution
- PMO, depends on focus
 - Focus on project execution, bad fit
 - Focus on project portfolio optimization, good fit

- **Lack of breadth**

- Business Unit IT is not ENTERPRISEWIDE; strategies at the BU level tend to be near-term, focused on annual targets and driving budgeting; lacks influence on other BU's and centralized operations, such as IT, finance, HR
- OK as an extension of a UNIFIED, federated EA Community with defined separation of responsibilities and decision rights authority

You need at least 1 person who has full-time EA responsibility.

{not sharing time with deadline-driven, fire-fighting responsibilities that will always take precedent}

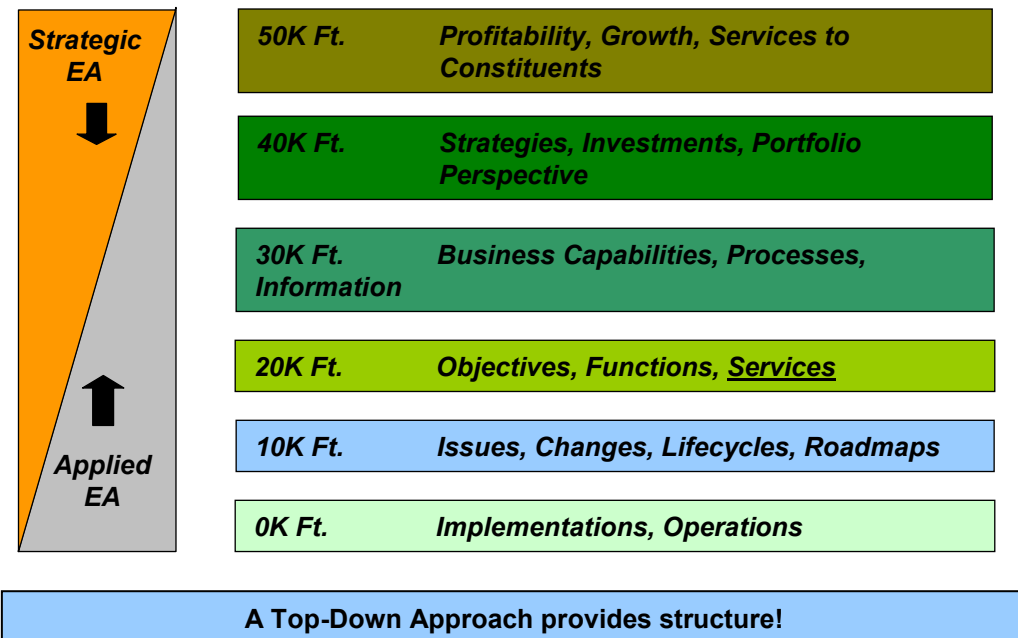
Step #4 – Draft Roles & Responsibilities

- **Roles**

- EA Sponsor
- EA Champion
- Chief Architect
- EA Core Team Leader and Member
 - Could be a specialist in a Domain (Business,
- Working Group Chair
 - Could be Core Team Member or SME
- Working Group Member
 - Domain groups should be filled with expertise from other domains
- EA Community Member
- Governance Roles
 - Executive Steering Committee
 - Architecture Review Board
 - Project Reviewers/Auditors
- Project/Solution/Domain Architects (Silo architects)
- EA Project Consultants

- **Responsibilities (see slide 6)**

- EA Planning
- EA Development
- EA Management
- EA Integration



Allocating Work: RACI Chart

- **Responsible**
 - The person(s) who will do an activity
- **Accountable**
 - The person who must ensure that the activity is done (usually only one person)
- **Consulted**
 - The person(s) from whom input is required before the activity is done
- **Informed**
 - The person(s) to whom information is reported after the activity is done



Activity	R	A	C	I
Organize Team	Jim	Ben	Tim	All IT managers
Plan Work	Sue	Jim	Project Mgrs	
Do Work	Jim, Sue, Don	Ben	App Dev Team	
Follow Up	Sue	Jim		

Step #5 – Staff / Kick off Working Groups



- **Working groups usually made up of SMEs**
 - Cross-functional expertise is beneficial when possible
 - Look for those who will collaborate and be open-minded
 - Sometimes you need a core and an extended group
 - Core gets things done, work well together
 - Extended includes those with necessary expertise, but difficult to work with
 - reviews and provides input to Core group; not included in final recommendations
- **Activities to get a group collaborating**
 - Reviewing and Refining Group Roles and Responsibilities
 - Defining Principles for the area of coverage
 - Developing a taxonomy / domain breakdown for organizing responsibilities, deliverables and access

Typical Progression

Establish and stabilize ETA process and deliverables

Apply ETA to applications/solutions portfolio

Establish and stabilize EBA process and deliverables

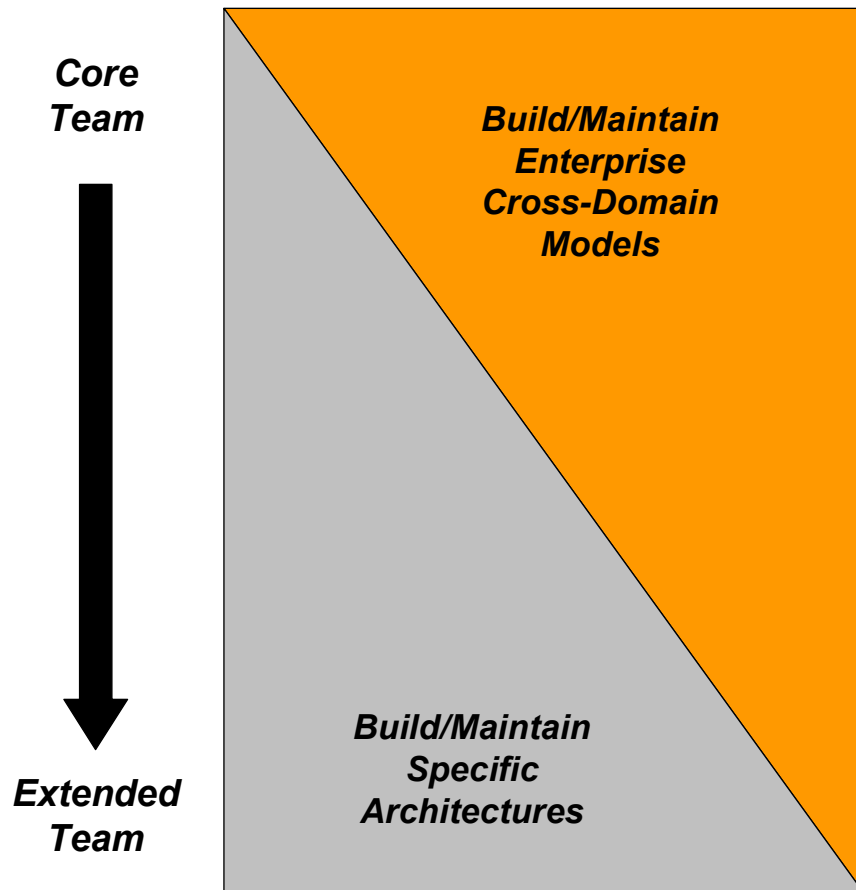
Establish and stabilize EIA process and deliverables

Establish and stabilize ESA process and deliverables

Continuous improvement of skills, governance, communication & integration

An EA Task Distribution Model

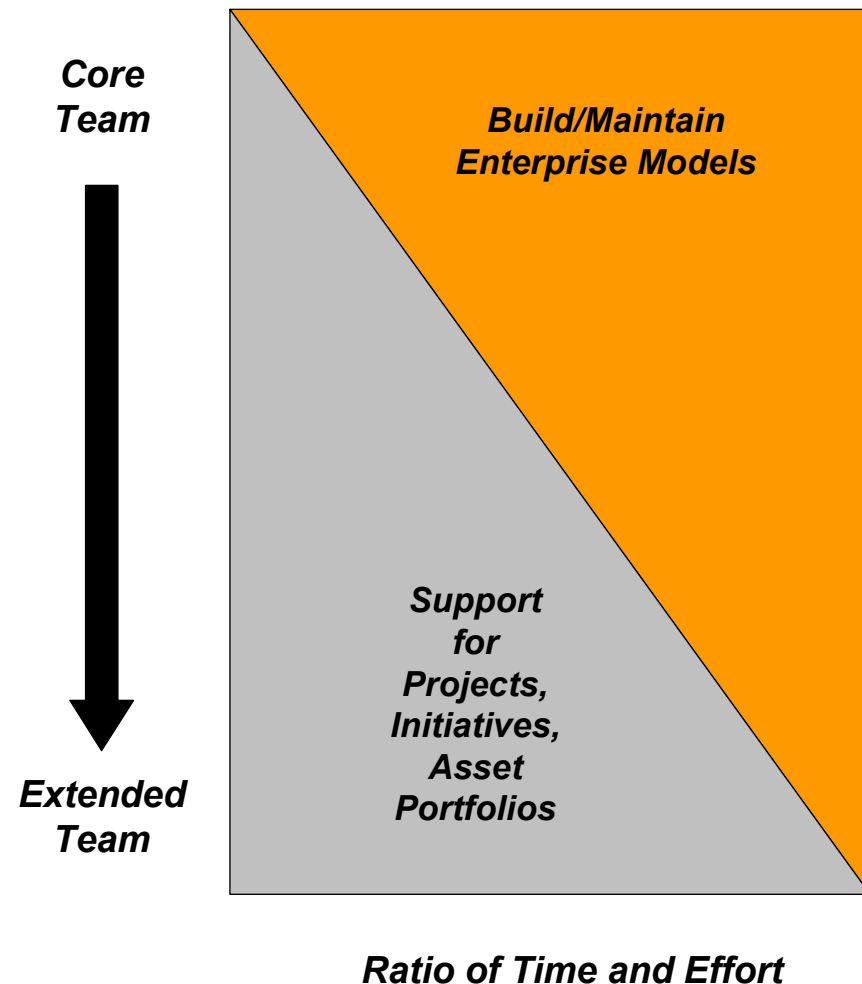
- **Intra-team focus**
- **Generalists vs. Specialists**
- **Enterprise Cross-Domain Models are difficult**
 - Few Skilled Practitioners
 - Reality – Value hard to justify, But you must!
- **Enterprise Business Architecture benefits from time spent cross-domain**
 - Top-Level strategy, value network models, etc.
- **Services-Oriented Architecture initiatives should driver focus upwards**



Ratio of Time and Effort

Another EA Task Distribution Model

- Task ratios vary across core and extended teams
- Many members wear many hats
- Internal vs. External focus
- Ratios change over time
 - EA Maturity
 - Program Evolution
 - Value Delivery requirements
 - Opportunistically
- Beware the **SLIPPERY SLOPE**



**Enterprise Architects should not be in
the role of Compliance Enforcement.**

{Core Team ≠ Standards Police}

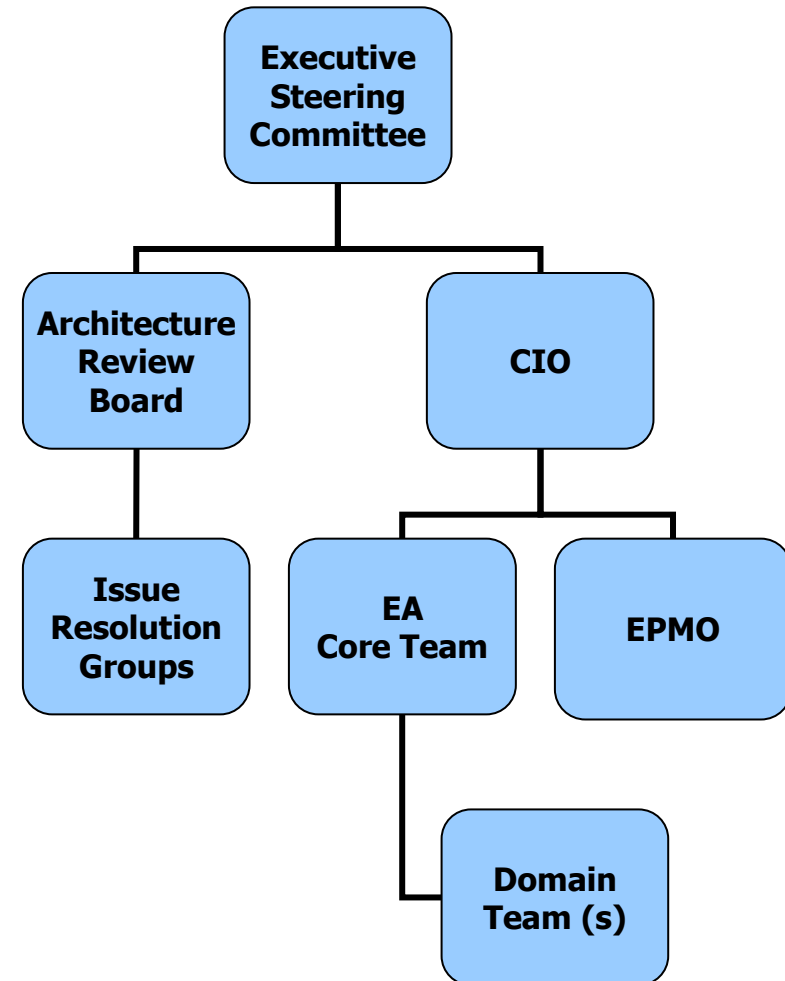
Step #6 – Extend Governance for EA

- Enterprise Governance is a consistent and interdependent system of **people**, **process**, and **policy** throughout the organization intended to ensure the **intentions of the enterprise leadership** are reflected in all decisions.
- Must be delegated authority by senior leadership
- Must understand strategy, EA and EPM; participation improves understanding
- Defines (approves) standards, policy, guidelines
- Must define consequences and apply them



Sample Organization Structure

- **Combination EA/Governance org structure**
- **Issue Resolution Groups are chartered as needed by ARB**
- **ARB members should be delegated authority by Steering Committee**
 - Mix of IT and business resources
- **Decisions get escalated to Steering Committee from ARB**
- **ARB ≠ EA Core Team**
 - EA Core Team is represented on ARB
- **EPMO takes on responsibility for EA compliance checks within SDLC**



**Collaboration is the key to your
organizational approach to EA.**

Step #7 – Establish Priorities for Each Group

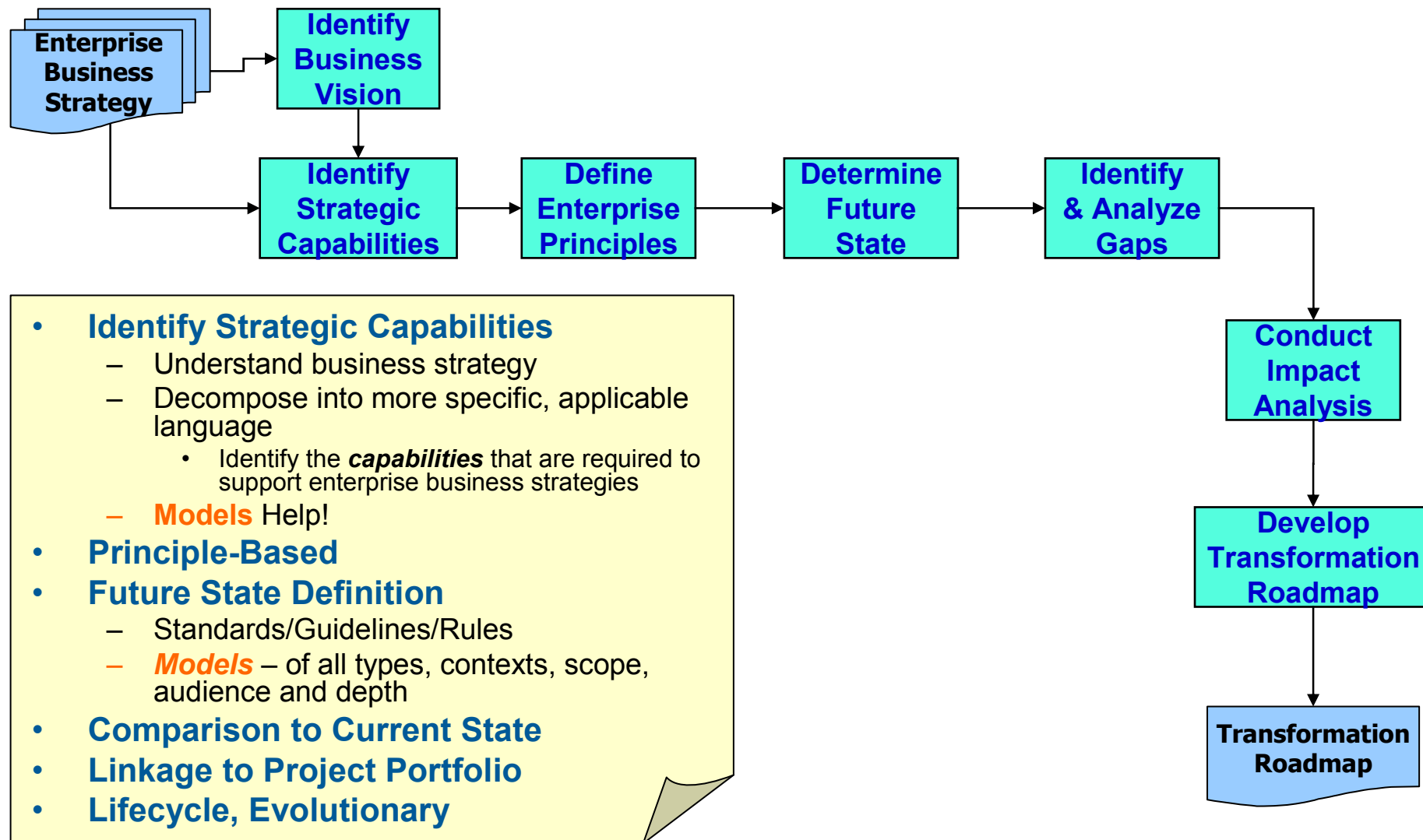


- **What information to collect?**
- **Which standards to work on?**
- **Which models to build?**
- **What areas to perform trends analysis?**
- **What matters to the business?**

HOW DO YOU DECIDE?

- **Depends on your level of maturity in a variety of areas**
- **Depends on your objectives**
- **Depends on your level of support**
- **Depends on where the EA Process takes you**

Enterprise Architecture Process



- Many Possible Paths
 - Technology-initiated
 - Initiative-based
 - Information-driven
 - Enterprise re-design (event-oriented, e.g. M&A)
 - Business process-driven
 - SOA-motivated
 - Organic
 - Opportunistic
 - Big Bang (consider yourself lucky if this works)
-
- Success Stories – Opposite Ends of the Spectrum
 - “One Man Show”
 - The (Almost) Ideal Situation

Adjust EA Team composition and members to reflect current and emerging needs.

Recapping the Steps to Building the EA Community of Practice

- **Define and Charter the EA Program**
- **Staff a Core EA Team**
- **Define the Team Structures and Relationships**
- **Draft Roles & Responsibilities**
- **Staff and Kick off Working Groups**
 - Agree on Roles & Responsibilities within each group
 - Define Principles for each group's area of coverage
 - Establish domain taxonomy, if necessary
- **Obtain Approval for and Staff Governance Groups**
- **Establish priorities for each group**



Our Mission

EAdirections is focused on improving the effectiveness of enterprise architecture (EA) teams by creating deep, mentoring relationships driven by independent research.

- **Founded by Larry R. DeBoever, George S. Paras, Tim Westbrook**
 - 50 years of combined experience in Enterprise Architecture
 - Launched the Enterprise Architecture Strategies (EAS) service at the META Group in 1996
 - Launched the EAC with Shared Insights (formerly DCI) in 1997
- **Key offerings:**
 - Coaching Relationship: 12 month EA advisory subscription with dedicated mentor
 - Teaming Relationship: 12 month subscription with dedicated mentor & significant on-site support
 - Rapid EA Assessments, Education, Briefings, and Workshops
- **Common client problems**
 - Need to 'jump start' or 're-start' EA effort; prioritize efforts; address resource/time constraints
 - Need to build executive or other internal support; gain credibility; improve artifacts or QA
 - Demonstrate (need for) alignment between business strategy, IT strategy, and Projects

Thought Leaders. Mentors. Deep Relationships.